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Maya Chen

Senior Backend Engineer | FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Data Platforms, Fintech Sy

Austin, TX, United States · maya.chen@example.test · likeding.test/in/maya-chen · 8,420 follower

11+	34%	99.96%
years experience	latency reduction	platform uptime

Engineering leader who turns ambiguous product problems into reliable backend systems. Known for designing clean service boundaries, improving database performance, and mentoring teams through pragmatic architecture decisions.

About

I build dependable financial and data products for teams that care about correctness, observability, and developer experience. Recent work includes modernizing a ledger ingestion platform, reducing query costs through targeted indexing, and introducing contract-first API practices across a multi-team backend organization.

Experience

Principal Backend Engineer

Northstar Ledger Labs · Jan 2023 - Present · Remote

- Led the redesign of transaction reconciliation services, reducing month-end processing time from 9 hours to 47 minutes.
- Introduced domain-oriented service modules, typed schemas, and migration review practices adopted by five engineering squads.
- Partnered with product and finance operations to launch anomaly detection workflows for high-volume account activity.

Senior Software Engineer

BrightBank Systems · Aug 2018 - Dec 2022 · Austin, TX

- Built FastAPI services for card, invoice, and brokerage data pipelines serving 2.4M monthly API requests.
- Improved PostgreSQL reporting workloads with query planning, partial indexes, and denormalized read models.
- Mentored engineers on repository patterns, integration testing, and incident response rituals.

Software Engineer

Signal Grove Analytics · Jun 2015 - Jul 2018 · Chicago, IL

- Created internal data quality tools that cut manual reconciliation review by 60%.
- Maintained Python ETL jobs, REST APIs, and dashboard-backed operational reporting.

Featured Projects

Balance Timeline Engine Event-sourced projection service for forecasting account balances across recurring invoices, installments, and

Migration Confidence Suite Docker-first Alembic validation workflow with seed data checks, rollback rehearsal notes, and production-readiness reporting.

Recommendations

“Maya has a rare ability to make complex backend tradeoffs feel clear. She leaves systems calmer and teams stronger.”

- Elena Ruiz, VP Engineering at Northstar Ledger Labs

Open To

Staff Backend Engineer roles, platform architecture consulting, and fintech reliability reviews.

Top Skills

FastAPI · PostgreSQL · SQLAlchemy · Domain-Driven Design · Alembic · Docker · Python · Observability · API Design

Certifications

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate

PostgreSQL Performance Tuning Workshop

Secure API Design for Financial Systems

Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

B.S. Computer Science · 2011 - 2015

Languages

English - Native

Mandarin - Professional working proficiency

Spanish - Conversational

Contact

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